MONDAY
AUGUST 25, 2025
RABI AL AWWAL 2, 1447

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS

Scan the QR code for updates and latest news on gulfnews.com

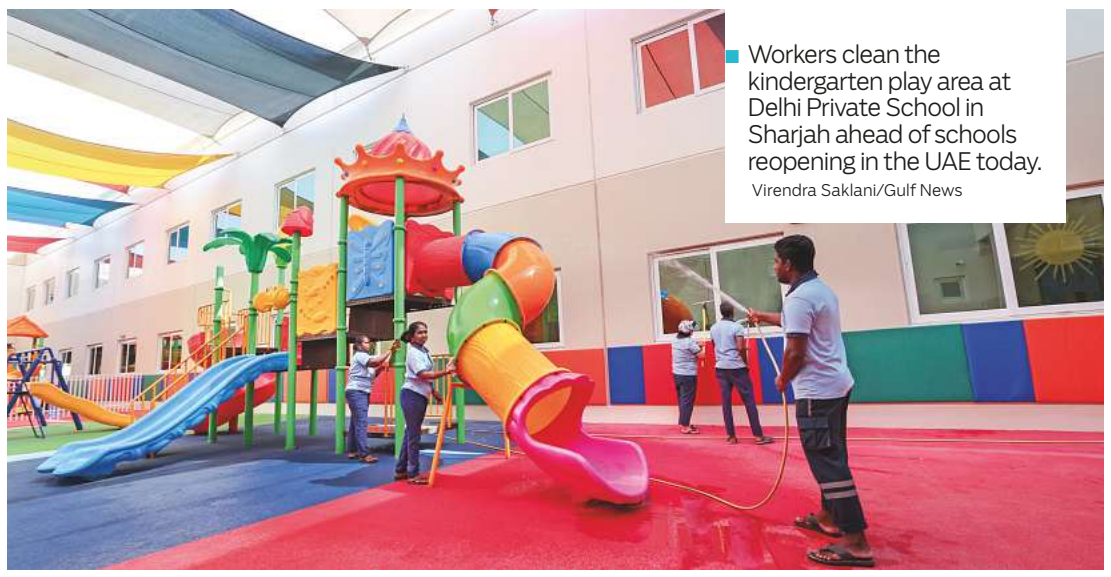
*T&C Apply
MEGA VALUE OFFERS
ABC CARGO & COURIER
800 916
www.abccargo.com
31543272_7.1

1 million students back to school

INNOVATIVE CURRICULA, AI LESSONS AND NO END-OF-TERM EXAMS TO MARK NEW ACADEMIC YEAR

DUBAI/ABU DHABI

BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter
ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor



Workers clean the kindergarten play area at Delhi Private School in Sharjah ahead of schools reopening in the UAE today.
Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

More than one million students, including 25,000 new entrants, will resume their studies as public and private schools across the UAE, along with kindergartens, prepare to welcome students back today, marking the start of the 2025–2026 academic year.

In a message to students and educators on his official X account, His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, wrote, "Tomorrow a new school year begins, with over one million students resuming classes across the country. New beginnings carry optimism, goodness, and hope. The start of the school year brings energy and momentum … Dynamism and activity across all parts of our country."

Under the newly restructured school calendar released by the Ministry of Education, UAE students will enjoy 135 days off during the academic year. The calendar shows the year will span 313 days, of which 178 will be instructional days.

School-based assessments

In addition, it has been decided to abolish centralised end-of-term examinations for the second semester across all grade levels and replace them with school-based final assessments.

Starting in the 2025–2026 academic year, AI will officially be taught in UAE schools as a core subject across public schools, from kindergarten through Grade 12. In parallel with embracing advanced technologies in education, a new mandatory framework has been introduced for private schools to ensure the teaching of Arabic, Islamic Education, and social concepts at the kindergarten level.

Back-to-school security plan

Given the large number of students returning to schools, Dubai Police have unveiled a comprehensive back-to-school security plan, including deployment of 250 security and traffic patrols to secure school zones, regular patrolling, monitoring traffic hotspots, and launching safety awareness campaigns for students and parents.

The Dubai Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) also has a robust student safety plan.

Abu Dhabi Police have, meanwhile, ramped up patrols and traffic awareness campaigns, focusing on school bus drivers and supervisors, while Sharjah Police conducted awareness sessions to guide bus drivers on student safety during transport. UAE authorities have also renewed their warnings against traffic violations around schools.

SEE ALSO P2

14,000 NEW SEATS FOR CHILDREN

Families in Dubai will soon have even more education options for children, with 25 new private institutions opening their doors in the 2025-26 academic year.

From nurseries to international universities, the expansion brings over 14,000 new seats for children and young adults. the Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) revealed yesterday, a day before the first day of the new academic year in most educational institutions and the reopening day after the summer vacation in others.

KHDA confirmed that the new institutions include 16 early childhood centres (ECCs), six schools, and three universities, a move that strengthens Dubai's position as a global hub for quality education.

"Together, these new institutions will add more than 11,700 new school seats," said KHDA.

— Sajila Saseendran, Chief Reporter

PROPERTY

Dubai developers woo first-time buyers with big discounts | P8

INDIA

Integrated Air Defence Weapon System tested successfully | P12

Subscribe In print and online
www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel : 600 587 234
E mail : circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 | Bahrain: BD 0.500 | Oman: RO 0.500 | India: Rs 40.00 | S.Arabia: SR 5.00 | Pakistan: Rs 100.00

31544321_2.1

THIS COULD BE YOUR AD.

Win up to **AED 100,000** worth of marketing support for your business.
Just share your entrepreneurial journey and claim your spotlight.

A&A ASSOCIATE LLC
OUR SERVICES. YOUR SUCCESS

SCAN THE CODE TO ENTER

31543756_5.1